

Chapter 98-2

When they came out, Liang Shi was still blocking Shen Hui's path.

The two stood there in confrontation. Shen Hui wasn't as tall as Liang Shi, so she half-tilted her head up to look at her. "I'm just an insignificant ex-girlfriend. I don't care about what's going on between you and Zhao Xuning."

"Well, I just want to tell you." Liang Shi stubbornly said, "Don't you want to see how happy Xuning and I are together?"

"I don't want to see." Shen Hui let out a light scoff. "You looked pretty happy when you were with your wife too."

Shen Hui shot her a disgusted look. "Just last night you were standing up for your wife, and today you're being all lovey-dovey with Zhao Xuning. You and Zhao Xuning really are a match made in heaven."

Liang Shi: "....."

"Huh?" Liang Shi's heart was already pounding nervously, but she still stubbornly replied, "Xuning and I are truly in love. You won't even give us your blessings—is it because you still have lingering feelings for her?"

Shen Hui: "....."

"How do you want me to give my blessings?" Shen Hui asked. "Should I record a Vlog for you two? Or wait until you get married and give you gift money?"

Shen Hui scoffed lightly. "I'd advise you to get divorced first, so you don't end up in prison for bigamy. Though even if you did go in, it wouldn't matter—Zhao Xuning could pull some strings to get you out."

Liang Shi: "....."

"Then Dr. Shen doesn't need to worry about that." Liang Shi acted in an affected manner. "Dr. Shen is so worried about Xuning—is it because you still love her?"

Shen Hui: ".....Get lost."

"You're this angry, which means you still love her." Liang Shi said, "Otherwise, why do you always speak to her so harshly?"

Shen Hui raised an eyebrow. Those light brown eyes looked straight at her, growing even more indifferent. "What does it have to do with you? Do you think that because your eyes look similar to mine, you're happy that Zhao Xuning fell in love with you? Do you think she really loves you? No. There's only one person she loves, and that's herself. Don't think too highly of yourself."

"So you think I'm your substitute?" Liang Shi said. "Then I'm willing to be a substitute. Since you and Xuning can't be together anymore anyway, I can stay by her side as a substitute for the rest of my life. If you have the ability, come back and steal her away from me."

Shen Hui: "....."

"She's all yours." Shen Hui sneered coldly. "It's something I didn't want anyway."

Liang Shi: "?"

Why wasn't this going the way she imagined?

Liang Shi shot Zhao Xuning a look, wondering how on earth she had offended the other woman.

Six years of dating, and they'd only been broken up for how long?

Every time they saw each other, there was clearly still love there. In all the corners where others couldn't see, Shen Hui still looked at Zhao Xuning with lingering attachment.

Liang Shi had seen it before. What misunderstanding couldn't be resolved by sitting down and talking it out?

Liang Shi decided to put in more effort for the two of them. "Zhao Xuning is so wonderful. It's really a pity if you don't want her. She's like an untouchable flower on a high peak¹ outside, but at home she's especially gentle."

Shen Hui: "Oh, everything you have now, I've already had. What are you showing off?"

Liang Shi: "But that's past tense, not present tense, and certainly not future tense."

"My future doesn't need Zhao Xuning in it." Shen Hui said coldly, then glanced at her watch. "If you want to show off how great Zhao Xuning is to me, let's end this here."

Zhao Xuning called out to her, "Shen Hui."

Shen Hui glanced at her—cold and distant—and said nothing. She turned to leave, but just as she turned around, she saw.....

Shen Hui suddenly smiled. She waved toward the entrance. "Hi, beautiful."

Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow at her and, in a rare moment of sweetness, said, "Pretty sister."

Liang Shi: "....."

Her body stiffened, and she slowly turned to look toward the entrance.

There stood Xu Qingzhu in casual clothes. She greeted Shen Hui first, then looked at Liang Shi.

.....

There was an awkward atmosphere in the air.

Zhao Xuning came over too. Xu Qingzhu asked, "Dr. Zhao, are you done? Can we go?"

Zhao Xuning nodded. "Mm, let's go."

"Pretty sister." Xu Qingzhu called to Shen Hui. "Let me treat you all to breakfast."

Shen Hui looked at her, then at Liang Shi, and then nodded. "Sure."

Liang Shi & Zhao Xuning: "....."

In that instant, Liang Shi wanted to find a crack in the ground to crawl into. On the way to the breakfast shop, Liang Shi secretly asked Xu Qingzhu, "When did you get here?"

Xu Qingzhu chuckled softly. "When you were telling Dr. Shen how happy you and Dr. Zhao are together."

Liang Shi: "....."

This was probably precious documentation of a massive public humiliation scene.²

Liang Shi still held onto a sliver of hope. "Then why didn't you call out to me?"

Xu Qingzhu chuckled softly. "Teacher Liang was acting so seriously, I got completely absorbed watching."

Liang Shi: "....."

"I was just trying to matchmake Zhao Xuning and her ex-girlfriend." Liang Shi explained with utmost sincerity. "I tried really hard."

"Yes, you tried hard." Xu Qingzhu patted her shoulder. "You tried hard to deliver the worst acting performance of your life."

Liang Shi: "....."

Xu Qingzhu smiled. "Dr. Zhao probably wants to grab a knife right now and silence you permanently."

From Xu Qingzhu's tone, Liang Shi detected not only passive-aggressive sarcasm but also schadenfreude.

Liang Shi tried to turn back to look at Zhao Xuning, only to see Zhao Xuning obediently following behind Shen Hui.

When Liang Shi looked over, Zhao Xuning raised her head and met her gaze, then made a throat-slitting gesture at her.

Liang Shi felt a chill on her neck and moved closer to Xu Qingzhu.

She couldn't help it—this was her first time doing something like this.

She hoped things would work out for Zhao Xuning.

Really.

From the bottom of her heart.

Liang Shi felt she had tried her best, it's just that... maybe... her efforts were slightly misdirected.

Zhao Xuning would understand, right?

Footnotes:

¹ "Untouchable flower on a high peak" (高嶺之花, gāolǐng zhī huā): A Chinese expression describing someone who appears cold, aloof, and unattainable—like a beautiful flower growing on a high mountain peak that ordinary people can only admire from afar but never reach.

² "Public humiliation scene" (社死現場, shè sǐ xiànchǎng): Internet slang literally meaning "social death scene." It refers to an extremely embarrassing situation where one wishes they could disappear from society due to the mortification.